

How to create a FLEX system (Part 1)

 flexonsbd.blogspot.com/2018/05/flex_4.html

Friday, May 4, 2018

(1) Obtaining FLEX.COR

Search the internet for "SWTPC emulator" and find "Evenson Consulting Services' SWTPC 6800/6809 Emulator". From the Downloads/Upgrades tab, ~~click Complete Setup current version to download SWTPCemuSetup.exe.~~

~~Run this on a suitable computer to install SWTPCemulator.~~ Two folders, FLEX6800 and FLEX6809, will be created in the Disks folder, each containing nearly 100 DSK files.

Open these DSK files with a binary editor and look at the Directory to find FLEXx.SYS and FLEXx.COR. (FLEX9.SYS for 6809, FLEX2.SYS for 6800)

(Correction on June 21) Following feedback, the above explanation has been corrected as follows:

From the Downloads/Upgrades tab, click FULL Kit to download SWTPCFULL.zip.

When you unzip this file, you will find SWTPCemuInstallIX.exe in the SWTPCFULL folder.

Running this will create an Evenson Consulting Services\SWTPCemu folder in the Program Files folder. The DSK file is located in the Disks folder within this folder.

(Correction July 1, 2019) There was a question about SWTPCFULL.zip, so I checked the Evenson Consulting Services website and found that the file location has changed.

I have written the new location in the answer to the question below, so please refer to that.

(2) Creating the Driver and Console I/O routines

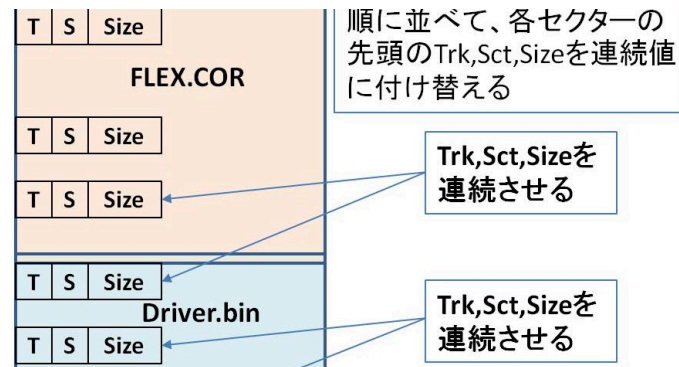
These two routines must be created to suit your system.

The Driver routine needs to be created according to the command response explained in How to create a Virtual Driver for FLEX (April 21).

I have uploaded the Driver routine and Console I/O routine for this 6809 single board that I use to GitHub.

(3) Create FLEX.SYS

Finally, you would normally connect the COR file, Driver, and Console I/O routines using the FLEX Append command, but the Append command cannot be used if FLEX is not running in the first place.



Schematic diagram of a binary file

As for what to do, the Append command simply concatenates the sectors of the three files COR, Driver, and Console, so you can just directly concatenate them using a binary editor. In the editor, place FLEX.COR, Driver.bin, and Console.bin side by side and directly rewrite the record number value of the first 4 bytes of each sector.

Then, write the starting sector, ending sector, and number of sectors of FLEX.COR to Directory, and rewrite the SIR information accordingly. I've uploaded [the Driver and Console routines](#)

I use to GitHub.